1. Overview

You have 4 hours to build NeoConnect — a staff feedback and complaint management platform. The system gives employees a safe place to raise issues, vote on polls, and see how management is responding. It should feel transparent, accountable, and easy to use.

Format	Individual
Time Limit	4 hours — strict; late submissions will not be evaluated
Deliverable	Working app with source code pushed to the provided repository

Here is what the system needs to solve:

- Every complaint gets a unique tracking ID and is assigned to a Case Manager — nothing gets lost
- If a Case Manager does not respond within 7 working days, the system escalates automatically
- A public hub shows how staff feedback has led to real changes in the company
- The system flags departments with recurring issues so management can act early

2. User Roles

The system has four types of users. Each role has specific access and actions.

Role	Who They Are	What They Can Do
Staff	All employees	Submit feedback or complaints (can be anonymous), vote in polls, read company updates and announcements
Secretariat / Management	Office managers or JCC reps	View all cases, assign them to a Case Manager, create polls, upload meeting minutes
Case Manager	A Management Rep or JCC Staff Rep	View cases assigned to them, update case status, add responses, close cases
Admin (IT)	IT team	Manage user accounts, handle security settings

3. Case Lifecycle

Every submission goes through a defined set of stages. This makes it easy to track progress and spot delays.

Status	What It Means
New	Submission just came in, not yet reviewed
Assigned	Secretariat has assigned it to a Case Manager
In Progress	Case Manager is actively working on it
Pending	Waiting on more information from the staff member
Resolved	Case has been addressed and closed
Escalated	7-day rule triggered — no response from Case Manager, Management has been alerted

4. Features to Build

4.1 Submission Form (Staff)

- A form for staff to submit feedback or complaints
- Fields: Category (Safety, Policy, Facilities, HR, Other), Department, Location, Severity (Low / Medium / High)
- Option to submit anonymously — a simple toggle that hides the submitter's name
- File upload — allow attaching a photo or PDF
- Every submission must get a unique tracking ID in the format NEO-YYYY-001

4.2 Case Management (Secretariat & Case Manager)

- Secretariat sees all incoming cases in an inbox view
- Secretariat can assign a case to a Case Manager
- Case Manager sees all cases assigned to them
- Case Manager can update the status, add notes, and close the case
- 7-day rule: if a Case Manager has not responded within 7 working days, send them a reminder and escalate to Management

4.3 Public Hub (Visible to All Staff)

- Quarterly Digest — a simple blog-style page showing summaries of resolved cases
- Impact Tracking — a table showing: what was raised → what action was taken → what changed
- Minutes Archive — a searchable list of uploaded meeting documents (PDFs)

4.4 Polling System

- Secretariat can create polls with a question and multiple options
- Staff can vote once per poll
- Results are shown as a simple chart after voting

4.5 Analytics Dashboard (Secretariat & Admin)

- A heatmap or bar chart showing which departments have the most open cases
- Case counts broken down by status, category, and department
- Hotspot flagging — if 5 or more cases from the same department share the same category, highlight it

5. Tech Stack

Use these technologies exactly as listed. Do not swap them without asking an organiser first.

5.1 Frontend

Technology	Purpose
Next.js	Main framework — use JavaScript or TypeScript
React	UI components
Tailwind CSS	All styling must use Tailwind
shadcn/ui	Component library for buttons, modals, forms, etc.

5.2 Animations (Optional)

You may use one of these for animations. Keep them subtle.

- Framer Motion
- GSAP

5.3 Backend

Technology	Purpose
Node.js	Server runtime
Express.js	API routes and server logic
MongoDB	Preferred database — use Mongoose to connect. You may use another database (e.g. PostgreSQL, MySQL) if you are more comfortable with it.

5.4 Authentication

Use JWT-based authentication. Users must stay logged in after a page refresh. Each API route must check the user's role before allowing access.

6. Rules

- Write all your code during the 4-hour session.
- Stick to the tech stack in Section 5. Ask first if you want to use something different.
- You can use extra libraries for specific things like charts or date pickers, but they should not replace shadcn/ui.
- Your app must run locally. Write clear setup instructions in your README.
- Put all environment variables (MongoDB URI, JWT secret, etc.) in a .env.example file — do not hardcode them.
- An organiser may ask you to walk through your code to confirm you wrote it yourself.

Good luck! Build fast, build clean.

Questions? Ask an organiser before the clock starts.